

Manifold Continuation

organ solo

Neil Thornock

Program note

The title comes from Wallace Stevens's poem "The Place of the Solitaires:"

Let the place of the solitaires
Be a place of perpetual undulation.

Whether it be in mid-sea
On the dark, green water-wheel,
Or on the beaches,
There must be no cessation
Of motion, or of the noise of motion,
The renewal of noise
And manifold continuation;

And, most, of the motion of thought
And its restless iteration,

In the place of the solitaires,
Which is to be a place of perpetual undulation.

Although, on the surface, the poem is about birds on a beach, the real subject matter is motion. Stevens captures the abstract quality of motion in the text itself. I attempted to do the same in a musical sense. Thus, the music is about motion -- motion within a section, motion from one section to the next, and the overall motion from the beginning of the work to the end.

Manifold Continuation was written for Dr. Don Cook.

Performance notes

This piece is performable on a two-manual organ, although a larger instrument with broad chorus possibilities is preferred.

Registration indications are given primarily in terms of dynamics. Specific indications are aids only in selecting particular registrations for the given instrument. Generally, registrations should be pyramidal, i.e., with a broad base of 8' stops. The performer is allowed great flexibility in selecting colors and combinations.

Performance in a reverberant hall is most desirable, allowing the music to undulate.

I, II: Broad, full, mellow (fl., str. 8)
no coupling!

Ped.: Matching I and II (fl., str. 16, 8)

Manifold Continuation

for Dr. Don Cook

Neil Thornock
Spring 2004

Very fast, mysteriously ♩ = 144

II.

Organ

p legato

I.

6

12

18

24

30



Gradually expanding, more joyful

35



40



45



50

Measures 50-54. The system consists of three staves. The top staff is in treble clef, the middle in bass clef, and the bottom in bass clef. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The music features a steady eighth-note accompaniment in the middle and bottom staves, with a more melodic line in the top staff.

55

Measures 55-59. The system consists of three staves. The top staff is in treble clef, the middle in bass clef, and the bottom in bass clef. The key signature has one sharp (F#). The music continues with the eighth-note accompaniment in the lower staves and a melodic line in the top staff.

60

Measures 60-64. The system consists of three staves. The top staff is in treble clef, the middle in bass clef, and the bottom in bass clef. The key signature changes to one flat (Bb). The music features a steady eighth-note accompaniment in the middle and bottom staves, with a more melodic line in the top staff.

65

Measures 65-69. The system consists of three staves. The top staff is in treble clef, the middle in bass clef, and the bottom in bass clef. The key signature has one flat (Bb). The music continues with the eighth-note accompaniment in the lower staves and a melodic line in the top staff.

70

75

suddenly explosive

6 3

Calm, melodic

p

Ped: -16, +solo stop (Krummhorn) or combination

mp

79

I: Solo stop or combination

Fluid, singing

mp

1.

84

89

This system contains measures 89 through 93. The treble clef staff features a melodic line with a half note G4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note Bb4, a quarter note C5, a quarter note Bb4, a quarter note A4, a quarter note G4, and a half note F#4. The middle staff has a continuous eighth-note accompaniment in the right hand and a bass line in the left hand. The bass clef staff provides a steady eighth-note accompaniment.

94

This system contains measures 94 through 98. The treble clef staff continues the melodic line with a half note E4, a quarter note D4, a quarter note C4, a quarter note B3, a quarter note A3, a quarter note G3, a quarter note F#3, and a half note E3. The middle and bass staves continue their respective accompaniment patterns.

99

This system contains measures 99 through 103. The treble clef staff has a half note D4, a quarter note C4, a quarter note B3, a quarter note A3, a quarter note G3, a quarter note F#3, a quarter note E3, and a half note D3. The middle and bass staves continue their accompaniment.

104

This system contains measures 104 through 108. The treble clef staff has a half note C4, a quarter note B3, a quarter note A3, a quarter note G3, a quarter note F#3, a quarter note E3, a quarter note D3, and a half note C3. The middle and bass staves continue their accompaniment.

109

113

I: 16, 8, 4, 2-2/3, 2, Trumpet 8
 II: 16, 8, 4, 2-2/3, 2, Oboe
 Ped.: 16, 8, 4, Bombarde 16
 I/Ped.

117

f Bold, angular, driving
 I. **ff**
fff

122

126

I: 8, 4, soft reed

poco f

131

fff

136

141

I and II: 16, 8, 4, 2, mix,
reeds 8, 4

II/I

impatiently

fff

3

3

3

145

3

angrily

3 6 II. *ff*

149

I: Full
II: Flute 8

Slowly, relenting ♩ = 96

II. *p*

153

160

I: Flute 8, 2-2/3

pp

ppp II: Celeste 8

I: 16, 8, 4, 2-2/3, 2, Trumpet 8

II: 16, 8, 4, 2-2/3, 2, Oboe

Ped.: 16, 8, 4, Bombarde 16

I/Ped.

Tempo I ♩ = 144

166 II.

f *ff* I.

171

176

180

184

poco accel. -----

188 (II.)

+II/I

I.

fff

Ped: Add stops

Slightly faster $\text{♩} = 152$

Increasingly majestic and joyful!

192

Ped: Add stops **ffff**

197

201 8^{va}

System 1 (Measures 201-204): Treble and bass staves. Treble staff features complex chords and arpeggios, with a dashed line indicating an octave transposition (8^{va}). Bass staff features a melodic line with a long sustain.

205 (8^{va})

System 2 (Measures 205-208): Treble and bass staves. Treble staff features complex chords and arpeggios, with a dashed line indicating an octave transposition (8^{va}). Bass staff features a melodic line with a long sustain. Pedal point instruction: Ped: Add stops.

209 (8^{va})

System 3 (Measures 209-212): Treble and bass staves. Treble staff features complex chords and arpeggios, with a dashed line indicating an octave transposition (8^{va}). Bass staff features a melodic line with a long sustain.

213 (8^{va})

System 4 (Measures 213-216): Treble and bass staves. Treble staff features complex chords and arpeggios, with a dashed line indicating an octave transposition (8^{va}). Bass staff features a melodic line with a long sustain.

(8^{va})

216

Tutti!

(8^{va})

219

(8^{va})

222

(8^{va})

225

Kick it!!

(8va)-----

228

(8va)-----

231

(8va)-----

234

(8va)-----

Don't slow down!

237